

Point of View (PoV) Statement

User + need + insight = a focused problem

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

A Point of View statement crystallises empathy research into one actionable problem framing, classically '[**user**] needs [**need**] because [**surprising insight**]'. It commits the team to a specific, human, insight-driven problem before ideation begins.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Formalised in the Stanford d.school process as the output of the Define stage.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

Vague problem statements produce vague solutions. A sharp PoV focuses ideation and gives a shared target the whole team can rally behind.

HOW IT IS USED

Teams mine empathy findings for a striking insight, then compose a PoV that is specific enough to guide ideas but open enough not to prescribe the solution.

WHEN IT IS USED

The Define stage, immediately before generating How Might We questions.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Design teams, product managers and facilitators.

FIGURE 1 · USER + NEED + INSIGHT



Figure 1. The PoV formula: [user] needs a way to [need] because [insight].

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO PRIOR PRACTICE

It turns synthesis into a **single, testable sentence**, the pivot between understanding and creating in the design-thinking process.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

How Might We (HMW) *Slibrary 6*

Empathy Map *Slibrary 5*

Define Success *Slibrary 10*

SOURCES (HARVARD · CITE THEM RIGHT)

Plattner, H. (2010) *An Introduction to Design Thinking: Process Guide*. Stanford: d.school.

Dam, R. and Siang, T. (2020) 'Define and Frame Your Design Challenge', *Interaction Design Foundation*.